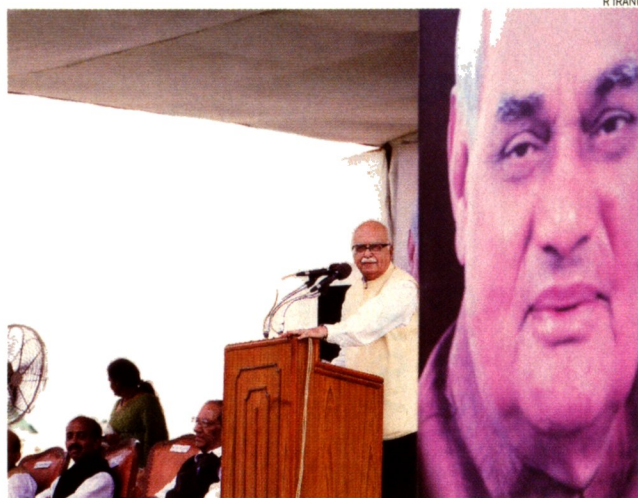




R IRANI

BATTLE CRY: Advani

capital was organised by Goel, the nomination is poised between Vardhan and Malhotra. For now, however, the party leadership is veering round to the Congress view that promoting a leader at this stage would only change a Congress vs BJP clash to a war of personalities. And neither contender is strong enough to take on Dikshit.

However, the BJP rally overshadowed the Congress show organised by Delhi MP Sajjan Kumar, a Dikshit baiter with the entire Congress leadership missing from the dais. In fact, the Congress had already announced a rally in mid-September where Sonia Gandhi is slated to give provisional certificates to residents of unauthorised colonies. Since this constitutes a large votebank, the BJP pre-empted Congress's move and held its own rally demanding the unauthorised colonies be regularised. Clearly, the capital capers have begun.

by Priya Sahgal

SIGNPOSTS

APPOINTED: Finance Secretary **Duvvuri Subbarao** as the governor of the Reserve Bank of India. He topped the IAS examination in 1972 and holds a Masters in Economics from Ohio University.

DIED: **Krishna Kumar Birla**, industrialist, former Rajya Sabha member and philanthropist at the age of 89 after a brief illness.



DIED: **Placid Rodriguez**, renowned metallurgist and former director of the Indira Gandhi Centre for Atomic Research. He was 67.

NAMED: **Vanisha Mittal Bhatia**, daughter of steel magnate Lakshmi Narain Mittal, as the world's richest heiress by the *Forbes* magazine. She was followed by Isha Ambani, daughter of Reliance Industries CMD Mukesh Ambani. Pia Singh, DLF founder K.P. Singh's daughter, figured third in the list.

Capital Capers

DELHI With elections approaching, it's rally time in the capital. The city witnessed three gatherings all in a day's work—the BJP, Congress and BSP all chose August 31 to kick off their respective election campaigns. The interesting fact, however, is: for a change, it is not the Congress but the BJP that is wary of declaring its chief ministerial candidate. The Congress has realised, somewhat belatedly, that its best chance of retaining Delhi is under Sheila

Dikshit's leadership. Despite 10 years of anti-incumbency, she still remains the party's tallest leader in the capital. The BJP too seems to have realised this and is looking for a strong leader to counter Dikshit.

While Arun Jaitley is best poised to take on Dikshit, he is reportedly not keen to be sidelined from central politics. The other contenders are Vijay Kumar Malhotra, Dr Harsh Vardhan and Vijay Goel. Although the recent show of strength in the

VIS-A-VIS **SHAHID AFRIDI** IPL's Deccan Chargers player **versus** **V.V.S. LAXMAN** Deccan Chargers captain

“
At times, Laxman lost the plot. Twenty20 cricket is not his forte. Adam Gilchrist is more comfortable in this type of cricket.”



SAURABH SINGH

“
Afridi has no team ethics. Speaking negatively about the team in public, let alone the captain, is just not on.”

”
EPILOGUE: Squabbles within the team only spell doom in future sporting events.